INCH-POUND

MIL-O-70548 (AR)
AMENDMENT 3
28 March 1991
SUPERSEDING
AMENDMENT 2
31 August 1990

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

OBTURATING BAND, PLASTIC SPLIT (MOLDED)

This Amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-O-70548 (AR), dated 5 September 1986, and is approved for use by the U.S. Army Armament Munitions and Chemical Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 1

1.1, Change "M853" to "M853A1"

PAGE 2

2.2, Under American Society of Testing and Material (ASTM):
Delete: "ASTM-D1238 - Test for Flow Rates of Thermoplastics by Extrusion Plastometer."

* Change "ASTM-D3935-80 - Polycarbonate (PC) Unfilled and Reinforced Materials" to read "ASTM-D3935-87-Polycarbonate (PC) Unfilled and Reinforced Material"

PAGE 3

3.2, delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"3.2 Molded parts. Obturators shall comply with the applicable requirements specified on drawing 9310339 and shall be produced by the injection molding process."

* 3.4, change "molded parts" to "material"

Change "Obturators shall meet the properties listed as follows (ASTM-D3935-80)" to read "Material used to produce the obturators shall meet the properties listed as follows (ASTM-D3935-87)."

Delete: "Flow rate...4.5 gram/10 minute"

Change: Flexural Modulus (min) from "2400" to "2100"

* Deflection temperature under a load at 1820 kilopascal (KPa) from "130 degrees centigrade" to "125 degrees centigrade"



DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-23T03:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

PAGE 3

Add new paragraphs 3.7 and 3.8 as follows:

"3.7 Proving ground test. The mean muzzle velocity of the test rounds which use the test obturators shall not differ more than 5 fps from that of the comparison samples with accepted obturators when determined by the statistical test (see 4.4.5.1.8). In flight, the obturator shall come off the test round within 20 feet from the muzzle of the mortar tube (see 4.4.3.2).

3.8 Chemical composition. The chemical composition for each lot of material shall be analyzed and furnished in accordance with 6.7 to AMCCOM, ATTN: AMSMC-QAT-B, Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000"

PAGE 4

4.3.3, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"4.3.3 Rejection. See MIL-A-48078 and 4.4.3.2."

PAGE 5

Under Ring, obturating (Dwg. 9310339) Add the following:

"Proving Ground Test 70...3.7...4.4.3.2"

Under Table I, change "molded parts" to "material"
Change "20" to "5"
Change "4.4.5.1.1" to "4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.1"
Change "4.4.5.1.2" to "4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.2"
Change "4.4.5.1.4" to "4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.4"
Change "4.4.5.1.5" to "4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.5"

Delete "Flow rate...5...3.4...4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.3"

PAGE 6

4.4.1.1, change "batch or run" to "lot"



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PAGE 7

Paragraph 4.4.2.1, Add Major 107 as follows:

"Physical properties of Material

| | |
|---|---|
| Izod impact strength (min) | 5...-...3.4...4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.1 |
| Tensile yield strength | 5...-...3.4...4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.2 |
| Flexural Modulus | 5...-...3.4...4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.4 |
| Deflection Temperature under a load at 1820 | 5...-...3.4...4.4.3.1/4.4.5.1.5" |

PAGE 8

4.4.3.1, delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"4.4.3.1, Physical properties of material. Representative specimens prepared from each lot of plastic material utilized for fabricating the first article and production lots of obturating rings shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.5.1. Five specimen samples shall be subjected to each physical property test. If any sample fails to meet any of the requirements specified in section 3.4, the lot of the plastic material shall be rejected."

Add new paragraph 4.4.3.2 as follows:

"4.4.3.2 Proving ground test. Twenty-five test obturators and twenty-five comparison obturators shall be selected for this test (see Table II). The test shall be performed as specified in 4.4.5.1.6. The lot shall be rejected if one or more groups of the test obturator fail to meet the accept/ reject criteria in Table III.

Table II Ballistic Performance

| Group | Obturator | Projectile | Charge | Temp (°F) | Quant |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Test | Note 8 | 4 | 70 | 25 |
| 2 | STD | Note 8 | 4 | 70 | 25 |
| 3 | Test | Note 8 | 0 | 145 | 5 |
| 4 | Test | Note 8 | 0 | -50 | 5 |
| 5 | Test | Note 8 | 4 | 145 | 5 |
| 6 | Test | Note 8 | 4 | -50 | 5 |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES: 1. All projectiles shall be from the same lot and +/- 0.05 lbs of its respective in-flight weight.
2. All rounds shall be assembled with acceptable ignition cartridges and propelling charges from the same lot.
3. All standard obturators shall be used from the same lot.
4. Group 1, 3, 4, 5 and 6 are the test groups.
5. Group 2 is the comparison group.
6. Standard obturators shall be selected from a lot of obturators that were accepted for use.
7. Rounds from group 1 and 2 shall be alternately fired in the same day.
8. To be determined based on availability.

TABLE III Performance Test Plan.

| Categories | Defects | Accept/Reject | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Major: | Misfire | 0 | 1 |
| Major: | Obturator not discarded from the round within 20 feet from the muzzle of the tube | 0 | 1 |
| Major: | The average muzzle velocities of the test group 1 differ from that of the comparison group 2 | (see 4.4.5.1.8)" | |

4.4.5.1.3, Delete in its entirety.

Add new paragraph 4.4.5.1.6, 4.4.5.1.7, and 4.4.5.1.8 as follows:

"4.4.5.1.6 Proving ground test. The test shall be performed at a government proving ground in accordance with the applicable USATECOM Acceptance Test Procedure.

All cartridges shall be fired from a standard, 81mm M252 mortar (hard mount) at an elevation of forty-five (45) degrees. The cartridges with the test obturators shall be separated into groups; group 1 of 25 rounds conditioned for 24 hours at +70°F ± 2.5°F, group 2 of 25 rounds with the



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T03:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

standard obturator shall be conditioned at +70°F ±2.5°F, group 3 of 5 rounds conditioned at +145°F ±2.5°F, group 4 of 5 rounds conditioned for 24 hours at -50°F ±2.5°F, group 5 of 5 rounds conditioned at +145°F ± 2.5°F and group 6 of 5 rounds conditioned at -50°F ± 2.5°F. The individual velocities shall be recorded on the firing record. The arithmetic averages shall be calculated and recorded. Temperature of the day, weather and the time of firing shall be recorded. Smear camera shall be used to photograph all samples. The camera shall be positioned to provide photo coverage of the test rounds at 20 feet from the muzzle of the mortar tube to determine whether the obturator has come off the round. Should any round fail to meet the requirement, a photo print of these rounds, and prints of all other rounds in that particular charge zone, in that lot, shall be attached to the firing record. Film from acceptable lots may be discarded.

4.4.5.1.7 Test validity. If for any reason ARDEC considers that the test conditions have detrimentally affected the test results, the test results shall be declared invalid and a new test shall be performed on additional sample cartridges.

4.4.5.1.8 Statistical test. Calculate $S_A$ for test group 1 and $S_B$ for comparison group 2 (see Table II).

Where $S_A$ = Standard deviation of the muzzle velocity of the twenty-five test samples.

$S_B$ = Standard deviation of the muzzle velocity of the twenty-five comparison samples.

$X_A$ = Average of the muzzle velocities of the twenty-five test samples.

$X_B$ = Average of the muzzle velocities of the twenty-five comparison samples.

If $S_A^2 > S_B^2$, Calculate $\frac{S_A^2}{S_B^2} = K$ (see Note 1 and 2)



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PAGE 8

Note 1: If $K < 2.27$ and $X_A$ is within $\pm 5$ fps of $X_B$, the test lot shall be accepted.

Note 2: If $K > 2.27$, the test shall be rejected.

Note 3: If $S_A^2 < S_B^2$ and $X_A$ is within $\pm 5$ fps of $X_B$, the test lot shall be accepted."

PAGE 9

6.1, change "M853" to M853A1"

6.4, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"6.4 Submission of inspection equipment designs for approval. See paragraph 6.2.3 of MIL-A-48078. Submit designs as required to:

Commander, U.S. Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command, ATTN: AMSMC-QAT-I (D), Bldg #62S, Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000."

"This address will be specified on the Contract Data Requirements List, DD Form 1423 in the contract. Unless otherwise specified, data item DI-R 1714 will apply."

6.5, Under Subject term (key word) listing., Delete "Flow rate."

Add new paragraph 6.6 and 6.7 as follows:

"6.6 Submission of test data. One copy of proving ground ballistic acceptance test data (i.e., firing record) shall be forwarded to each of the following:

Commander, U.S. Army Armament Research, Development and Engineering Center, ATTN: AMSMC-QAT-B (D), Bldg #62S, Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000.

6.7 Data requirements. Deliverable data required by this specification is cited in the following paragraphs.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T03:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

| Paragraph No. | Data Requirement Title | Applicable DID No. |
|---|---|---|
| 3.8 | Test and demonstration report | DI-T-1906 |

(Data item descriptions related to this specification, and identified in section 6 will be approved and listed as such in DOD 5000.19L, Vol. II, AMSDL. Copies of data item descriptions required by the contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the Naval Publications and Forms Center or as directed by the contracting Officer)."

The margins of this amendment are marked with an asterisk or vertical lines to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous amendment were made. This was done as a convenience only and the government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous amendment.

Custodian:
Army-AR

Preparing activity
Army-AR

(Project 1395-A261)



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T03:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.